One More Time

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/52597501.

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Not Rated

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F/F

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra)

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by WritteroftheNight

Summary

In this emotionally charged narrative, Catra encounters Adora after nearly a decade of separation. Their reunion in a dimly lit bar evokes a flood of emotions, and a spontaneous kiss leads to a series of revelations and a rediscovery of their connection. The story unfolds in a small town, in the unlikeliest of places, and the past decade melts away as the two women confront their feelings for each other. The conflicting emotions, the intensity of the moment, and the realization of long-buried desires create a complex and captivating narrative. The story explores themes of love, fear, and the inevitability of facing one's true feelings.

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

Her movements were followed by eyes of heterochromatic charm, fixated on her as those strikingly blues seemed to emit a faint glow within the dimly lit bar. She surveyed her in a stunned silence and attended her face, noticing every subtle change that the passing decade had brought. As they trailed over her lips, now moistened by a swift swipe of her tongue, an intense sensation engulfed Catra, drawing her irresistibly closer. With only a breath's distance between them, her own eyes lowered, weighed down by the gentle flutter of her thick lashes.

The rosy swell of plump, glistening lips appeared as if poised, seemingly waiting for something. But waiting wasn't Catra's style. Catra’s lips brushed into hers, it was everything she had desired and more. The gentle graze of familiar lips against hers was brief, cautious, and far too fleeting for Catra's liking. Acting on instinct, she pressed herself closer to the woman's tall and sturdy frame, her hands encircling a strong neck, entangling in the silky blonde tresses. In a practiced motion, her fingers deftly undid the elastic that held the golden cascade of hair from toned shoulders.

The woman’s sigh enveloped Catra like an addictive elixir, something she knew she could never resist. She eagerly swallowed that intoxicating sound as deft hands tugged at her hips, drawing them tighter together. The taller figure bent to meet Catra's insatiable hunger, as if they both were about to be consumed by the intensity of this moment. Catra understood, deep down, that the nearly decade they had spent apart had led them to this very moment. No matter how hard she had tried to run from it, the thought of her persisted, always present in her mind, alive in her dreams, and haunting her from the shadows of her consciousness. Surrendering to their feelings had become an unavoidable fate.

The circumstances were undeniably unusual - in a small town far away from their past, in a pub in the basement of her staff accommodations. Yet, when Catra walked in, the familiar laughter filled the air, just as it had in countless dreams. Even now, as skillful hands drew her close and delved into the depths of who

Catra was, she couldn't shake the feeling that it was partly a dream, a surreal moment she did not believe was real.

As their chests pressed together, quivering and reluctant to pull away even for a breath, Catra felt torn. Part of her wanted to never let go, to take her last breath and fall endlessly into this dream. She considered letting her dizzy head consume her, continuing this seemingly unreal experience in her unconsciousness, if only to hold onto the overwhelming sense of fulfillment and completeness.

"Catra," Adora's voice trembled, deeper and filled with a desire Catra had never considered possible.

"Mhm," Catra hummed, her eyes fluttering open, absorbing the sight of the face before her.

So much had remained unchanged, yet so much was different now. They were no longer the scrawny, round-faced teens of the past. Catra noticed the gentle imprints of time, leaving its mark at the corners of Adora's eyes and the edges of her lips. Her fingers delicately traced over the small smile lines, which had deepened with the years, especially as Adora smiled shyly in response to her touch.

The intense heat of the previous moment transformed into something simmering and warm, more familiar, and something Catra had desperately yearned for. Yet, it also felt unnerving, the stark reality of it all. Had what she had longed for so intensely finally come to pass? The idea had never been given room to exist in her life, only residing in the confines of her mind. The sudden collision of her dreams with reality left her exhilarated and unsettled, forcing her to confront the fact that her deepest desires had somehow become her reality.

"Catra, are you alright?" Adora's low and warm voice now tinged with concern.

Catra gazed into those mesmerizing blue eyes once more, as wave after wave of panic washed over her. This was real; this was Adora, not just some pretty blonde she had picked up in bars like this before. It was actually her. Her Adora.

"I-I," Catra stammered, retreating until her back met something sharp, and when she glanced behind, she noticed the dart Adora had thrown, now sticking out of the wall, she had missed when their eyes had met. As Catra surveyed the room, she became aware of several pairs of eyes fixed on her, and one person, in particular, seemed quite upset by the unexpected interruption.

Her body felt numb, as if she had been floating in space all along the way when she closed the distance to Adora. Not a word escaped her lips as she pressed closer, surrendering to the long-held fantasy she had entertained countless times before. Catra's arms wrapped tightly around her stomach, attempting to contain the surge of panic that threatened to overwhelm her. The weight of the moment and the reality of being so close to Adora seemed almost too much to bear.

Adora's hand extended towards Catra as she continued to retreat, her body instinctively rebelling with each step, desperate to put distance between them. She couldn't stop herself; the overwhelming emotions pushed her to keep running, to deny the reality of what had just happened. It couldn't have been real, she thought.

With determined steps, Catra turned and hastened towards the exit, intent on escaping this trick of fate. However, just as she was about to make her escape, Adora's hand firmly caught hers, she pulled them both out into the chilly night, her heart beating against her chest.

"Catra, wait," Adora's voice was raw, filled with concern and a pain that Catra could recognize all too well. It mirrored the same voice she had heard the last time they spoke, and the memory of that moment, so similar to this one, hit her with a sharp pang—vivid and painful.

Catra paused, her heart warring with conflicting emotions. She longed to return to the warmth of Adora's embrace, but a deep rooted fear and uncertainty held her in place.

"I shouldn't have done that," Catra whispered to herself, her voice barely audible, but Adora heard it nonetheless.

"What, why?" Adora's response came, tinged with annoyance more than anything else. Under different circumstances, Catra might have found it amusing, but not in this moment, not after their first kiss. A kiss that Catra had allowed herself to savor, one she could still taste on her tongue and feel against her lips. She shook her head, trying to collect her thoughts.

"I wasn't thinking," Catra confessed, still unable to face Adora directly, until she felt a gentle hand resting on her shoulder, silently pleading for her to turn and meet the gaze of the woman she had been running from all this time. Eventually, Catra mustered the courage to glance over her shoulder, and immediately, she wished she hadn't.

"Thank god for that," Adora huffed out a laugh, a warm smile adorning her perfect features.

Adora had always been strikingly beautiful. Her eyes were a bright blue that almost glowed when she was happiest. Her chiseled jawline stood high in moments of pride or when she protected Catra in their youth, always seeming so much bigger for their age. It felt incredibly unfair that all her features were so brilliant, especially on top of the golden trail of shimmering locks that flowed aimlessly over her shoulders in the gentle breeze. Catra longed to catch it in her hands again, to feel its silky tangle once more, perhaps forever if she dared to dream.

Catra felt her heart race, the mixture of emotions made her stomach swirl in a very unpleasant way. Adora's reaction was not what she expected, and the tenderness in her eyes ignited a spark of hope within Catra's heart. Yet, fear always persisted.

"What are you doing here, Adora?" Catra's voice was angrier than she had intended. Not that it was out of character for her, but she didn't blame Adora for wincing at the tone. Catra had to quell her own reaction to it. She took a step away from the woman, her hand falling from Catra's shoulder as she did.

"I- I just moved here," Adora stammered, as if her response justified the choice of this peculiarly remote place Catra sought solitude in—as if it were a perfectly reasonable location for someone to find themselves.

Catra observed her closely, anticipating more information. But in that fleeting moment, she absorbed more facets of Adora's presence, noting the subtle things like the growing strength in her shoulders and the transformation of once slender limbs into something more alluring and robust. Catra longed to go back to that comforting embrace, to feel Adora's arms around her again, to sense the reassuring solidity beneath her touch, and to have Adora beneath her hands, committing the memory of her body through sensation alone.

"It's my residency placement," Adora finally spoke, the pause lingering uncomfortably. Adora, who always found silence challenging—a trait Catra never could appreciate. Catra shook her head slightly, attempting to dispel wandering thoughts, as she sought to make sense of Adora's words.

"You work here, at the hospital, as a resident?" The words made sense, the truth laid bare before her. However, Catra couldn't quite grasp the implications of what that meant, neither for herself nor for the little life she had built in this place.

"Yes?" Adora responded slowly, cautiously advancing toward Catra. On instinct, Catra took a step back, noting the subtle shift in Adora's gaze and the slight slump of her shoulders. Unfortunately, it was a familiar sight for Catra—disappointment, an unmistakable tell.

"I- Wh-When did you start? I haven't seen you in rounds," Catra stammered, grasping at straws. How had she not noticed Adora in her own hospital?

"I did my interview this morning, and they hired me on the spot. I start Monday," Adora explained. Her eyes held a mix of defeat and hope as she observed Catra.

The snow began to fall around them, big, heavy, fluffy chunks—Catra's favorite since she moved here two years ago. She chose a drafty loft suite in the residents' housing for the big window overlooking the mountain range to watch the snow. Hours were spent studying as it piled up over her quiet little town. Now, the serene scene would forever be tainted by the look in Adora's eyes as she reached out, and Catra's habitual retreat.

Fluffy snow clung to Adora's golden hair, light catching her blue eyes like falling snow, and her bare shoulders showed goosebumps in the cold night. Their breaths were the only touch high above, synchronized as always in each other's presence. It was all so complicated yet simple, erecting desires, feelings, and one of the most guttural fears Catra had ever known. How could it be so right and so wrong at the same time?

"Catra, please," Adora implored, slowly placing her hand between them. "Lets talk," She held her hand out, eyes fixed on Catra's. "I've missed you," she said quietly, so quietly. The statement nearly broke Catra. She turned her face into the darkness of the parking lot, tears threatening the edges of her eyes. Catra was careful not to let any spill—no need for evidence of her weakness in the running of her mascara.

"Please, Catra, don't leave me again," Adora's voice was incredibly soft, as if they hadn't broken each other's hearts time and time again. It carried a wish for another chance, as if Catra deserved it.

"I-I can't," was all Catra could manage, the words slipping through clenched teeth as she fought to suppress the sob building within her. She took step after forced step into the darkness of the

parking lot. Distance was a known friend, an ally in her fear, safety in solitude.

Two steps in, and she hadn't heard Adora's footsteps behind her.

"And what about me, what I want?" Adora's hand shot out in an instant, a move she had never tried before, never having stopped Catra from leaving. As Catra's eyes trailed up the arm that held her in place, both women's features must have mirrored the others. They looked surprised and dumbfounded to find themselves in this predicament.

The silence that followed was thick, weighted with a decision that would change both of their lives. A question lingered in Catra's mind, unable to stop its existence. She stared down into those hauntingly beautiful eyes, watching as the snow fell around them like a shroud to the world around them.

"And what do you want, Adora?" Catra's voice was quiet, almost sad. How could she possibly know the thoughts of the nearly stranger before her? The time spent apart, the lives they had lived without the other.

But now she knew the taste of her lips, the warmth of those arms around her, the sound Adora made when she couldn't hold it together a second longer. How many more things were there to know, and how deeply Catra wished she could discover them.

As she watched, the question registering in those gorgeous eyes, Catra never expected the answer she was faced with. Adora's eyes trained on Catra's next breath as she took step after step. Catra hadn't even thought of running, not when that look said everything, not as those arms wrapped around her, firmer this time, possessive even. Adora leaned down, her mouth taking Catra's, and take it did as Catra gave in to Adora's answer. Her own lips parted in response, surrendering to the moment. It was Catra this time who lost control, the sound that emanated from her only spurring Adora further. Her hands grabbed tighter, pulling Catra's slight frame closer as she delved deeper into the kiss,

claiming what Catra had run from every time they had come too close to this.

Catra felt the hot stream of tears staining her cheeks, but she could hardly care. Her hands found their way into that silky golden hair as she held onto the most tremendous kiss of her life. Taking all Adora gave and more, she pushed herself into the woman. Catra didn't miss the turn of Adora's lips as she did so, nor did she let Adora pull away for even a breath as she kissed her again. Adora laughed into the kiss this time, and Catra smiled into the mouth pressed to hers. Neither woman could help themselves as they smiled into the other, their laughter quiet but mingling, as Adora rested her forehead onto Catra's.

"You, it's always been you, Catra," she smiled as she stole a kiss.

Adora brushed the tears from Catra's cheeks as she held the smaller woman. For once, Catra didn't feel so afraid. Something in this wild declaration felt completely different yet so very familiar. With a warmth in her chest and strong arms wrapped around her, Catra found an odd sense of peace.

The snow continued to fall around them, the world kept spinning, and the night went on. The two women found time to talk, to work out what issues could be in a night, and Catra discovered some of those sounds she had longed for, had dreamed about, and would forever remember… and so did Adora.

End Notes

Goodnight, my sweet readers. It was great to be writing again. Happy Holidays, and have an amazing New Year.

With love,

Writ.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!